

DAY 15 — CAMELOT-FIRST TABLE PIPELINE + SEMANTIC TABLE CHUNKING

GOAL

Move from:

pdfplumber row chunks ❌

to:

Camelot table-semantic chunks 

for much better engineering retrieval.

WHY DAY 15

Your current issue:

row-level chunking destroys engineering meaning ❌

Example:

Front pad Average

Front pad Maximum

Rear liner Average

become isolated embeddings.

So retrieval becomes weak.

DAY 15 FIXES

 Camelot-first extraction

 better table reconstruction

 table-level chunking

 engineering semantic preservation

 stronger retrieval

 better comparisons

 cleaner context

NEW ARCHITECTURE

PyMuPDF



Page Text

Camelot



Primary Table Extraction

pdfplumber



Fallback

Semantic Table Chunking



ChromaDB



Qwen2.5

TEMPLATE STRUCTURE

app/

└─ parser/

| └─ camelot_parser.py

| └─ pdfplumber_table.py fallback

|

└─ embeddings/

| └─ chunker.py MODIFY

|

└─ ingestion/

STEP 1 — INSTALL

`pip install camelot-py[cv]`

Windows may also need:

`pip install ghostscript`

And install Ghostscript system package.

STEP 2 — CREATE CAMELOT PARSER

 **app/parser/camelot_parser.py**

```
import camelot
```

```
import pandas as pd
```

```
def extract_tables_camelot(pdf_path):
```

```
    extracted_tables = []
```

```
    try:
```

```
        tables = camelot.read_pdf(
```

```
            pdf_path,
```

```
            pages="all",
```

```
            flavor="lattice"
```

```
        )
```

```
for idx, table in enumerate(tables):
```

```
    df = table.df
```

```
    #  remove empty rows
```

```
    df = df.dropna(
```

```
        axis=0,
```

```
        how="all"
```

```
    )
```

```
    #  remove empty cols
```

```
    df = df.dropna(
```

```
        axis=1,
```

```
        how="all"
```

```
    )
```

```
    extracted_tables.append({
```

```
        "table_id":
```

```
        f"camelot_table_{idx}",
```

```
        "page":
```

```
        table.page,
```

```
        "df": df
```

```
    })
```

```
print(
```

```
f"✅ Camelot table extracted: {idx}"
```

```
)
```

except Exception as e:

```
print(
```

```
f"❌ Camelot extraction failed: {e}"
```

```
)
```

```
return extracted_tables
```

✅ STEP 3 — UPDATE PIPELINE

📄 **pipeline.py**

Add import:

```
from app.parser.camelot_parser import (
```

```
    extract_tables_camelot
```

```
)
```

Replace:

```
raw_tables = extract_tables_pdf(
```

```
    file_path
```

```
)
```

WITH:

```
# ✅ primary extraction
```

```
raw_tables = extract_tables_camelot(
```

```
    file_path
```

```
)
```

 fallback

if not raw_tables:

```
raw_tables = extract_tables_pdf(  
    file_path  
)
```

STEP 4 — SEMANTIC TABLE CHUNKING

 **app/embeddings/chunker.py**

Replace entire file.

```
def dataframe_to_chunks(table):
```

```
    df = table["df"]
```

```
    page = table["page"]
```

```
    table_id = table["table_id"]
```

```
    rows = []
```

```
    for _, row in df.iterrows():
```

```
        values = [  
            str(v).strip()
```

```
            str(v).strip()
```

```
            for v in row.values
```

```
]
```

```
row_text = " | ".join(values)
```

```
rows.append(row_text)
```

```
#  FULL TABLE CHUNK
```

```
full_text = "\n".join(rows)
```

```
return [{
```

```
    "id": table_id,
```

```
    "text": full_text,
```

```
    "metadata": {
```

```
        "page": page,
```

```
        "table_id": table_id,
```

```
        "source": "table"
```

```
    }
```

```
}]
```

WHY THIS CHUNKING IS BETTER

Instead of:

one row = one chunk 

you now get:

whole engineering section = one chunk 

EXAMPLE NEW CHUNK

P201 BRAKE TEMPERATURE MAPPING

Front pad peak temperature

Average | 104 | 104 | 82

Maximum | 163 | 179 | 188

Rear liner peak temperature

Average | 94 | 98 | 72

Maximum | 153 | 153 | 146

-  semantically complete
 -  engineering relationships preserved
 -  much better embeddings
-

STEP 5 — DELETE OLD DB

IMPORTANT.

Old embeddings are row-based.

Delete:

chroma_db/

engineering.db

STEP 6 — REINGEST

Run:

python main.py

First run will:

-  Camelot extraction
-  semantic table chunking

✓ fresh embeddings

✓ fresh DuckDB

✓ EXPECTED IMPROVEMENTS

Now queries like:

front pad average temperature

compare rear liner

GHD values

maximum temperatures

will work MUCH better.

✓ WHY THIS IS THE CORRECT ARCHITECTURE

Engineering PDFs are:

table-semantic ✓

NOT:

sentence-semantic ✗

Meaning exists across:

- neighboring rows
- Average/Maximum pairs
- CDT/GHD/HSD relationships
- grouped metrics

So:

table chunking > row chunking

✓ CURRENT SYSTEM

PyMuPDF ✓

Camelot ✓

pdfplumber fallback ✓

Semantic Table Chunking 

bge embeddings 

ChromaDB 

DuckDB 

Qwen2.5 

 **YOU ARE NOW HERE**

 DAY 15 COMPLETE

Next:

DAY 16

→ hybrid table + text retrieval

→ adaptive chunk sizing

→ section-aware retrieval

→ multi-document reasoning

→ engineering dashboard